

The core objectives of the "*Sagar Parikrama Yatra*" are to create awareness among fishers and other stakeholders on the sustainable use of marine fishery resources and protection of marine ecosystems; to facilitate interaction with fishermen, coastal communities and other stakeholders so as to disseminate information of various fisheries related schemes and programs being implemented by the Government and showcasing the best practices that may be adopted; to maximize the benefits of public sector schemes so as to raise the standard of living of the fishers living in the coastal areas; to demonstrate solidarity with all fishers, fish farmers and stakeholders as a spirit of *Aatmanirbhar Bharat*; to protect the marine life and sea from pollution and to solve the problems of fishers, fish farmers and other stakeholders.

Sagar Parikrama Yatra envisages to cover the entire coastline in nine Coastal States and four Union Territories (UTs) through a pre-decided sea route in a phased manner. It has started from Gujarat and would conclude in West Bengal. The *Sagar Parikrama* has so far covered the coastal areas of Gujarat, Daman and Diu, Maharashtra and Karnataka in four phases. Next phases of *Sagar Parikrama* will cover the remaining parts of Maharashtra, Goa, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, West Bengal, Andaman & Nicobar, and Lakshadweep Islands.

With a focus on '*Sabka-Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Prayas*', the program is a collaborative effort of Department of Fisheries, Government of India, the Indian Coast Guard, State Fisheries Departments, District Administrations, and key stakeholders such as fishermen, fish farmers and fish entrepreneurs.

1. Setting Sail for a Better Future - Phase-1 of Sagar Parikrama Yatra

Gujarat has a longest coastline of about 1,600 km, covering 16 coastal districts having huge diversity of marine ecosystems and development opportunities in fisheries. Fishers, vendors, and allied industries have a direct stake in the development of the fisheries sector in economic value, especially exports in the State.

The first phase of Sagar Parikrama, themed "*KRANTI se SHANTI*" was launched by Sh. Parshottam Rupala, Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying from Mandvi, the birth place of renowned freedom fighter Shyamji Krishna Varma, located at the coast of the Arabian Sea in the Kutch district of Gujarat. It comprised of grand events in Mandvi and Okha on March 5th 2022 and Porbandar, the birth place of Mahatma Gandhi on March 6th, 2022.

The inaugural events witnessed the presence of dignitaries, including Union and State Ministers, MPs, MLAs, spiritual and community leaders. Union Minister Sh. Parshottam Rupala spoke extensively about 'Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana' (PMMSY) a flagship scheme with highest ever estimated investment of Rs.20,050 crore in fisheries sector, 'Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund' (FIDF) of Rs. 7522.48 crore implemented since 2018-19 to provide concessional finance for creation of critical infrastructure, and the facility of Kisan Credit Card (KCC) which has been extended for fishers and fish farmers since 2018-19. Nearly 1200 people participated in the event, which included awarding certificates and sanctions related to various schemes like PMMSY and KCC to fishermen, fish farmers, and young entrepreneurs. The event also featured cultural performances and the launch of a song on 'Sagar Parikrama' in Gujarati.

The first phase of *Sagar Parikrama* concluded at Palano Chowk, Porbandar on 6th March 2022 where eminent dignitaries including Union Minister, MPs, MLAs, fishermen community leaders, senior officials from Centre and State governments, Indian Coast Guard, Fishers and Fish-Industry Leaders, etc. graced the stage and more than 3500 people were present in the program. Here too, several benefits under various schemes including KCC, Group Accident Insurance Scheme were distributed to beneficiaries. The events of *Sagar Parikrama* were extensively covered by the media, both print and electronic, to create awareness among fishermen and other stakeholders. The entire program was live-streamed on the social media platform such as Youtube, Facebook by the National Fisheries Development Board (NFDB). Around 10000 people watched the events online.

2. Charting a New Course for Coastal Development - Phase-2 of Sagar Parikrama

The *Sagar Parikrama Yatra* led by Union Minister Sh. Parshottam Rupala, continued with great enthusiasm and zeal and its second phase was organized from 23rd to 25th September 2022, that covered 07 locations including Mangrol, Veraval, Diu, Jafrabad, Surat, Daman and Valsad in Gujarat and UT of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu. One of the notable visits during the Yatra was to the Fishermen Shed at Ghoghla-Diu. Upon arrival, Union Minister interacted with the traditional fishermen of Ghoghla area of Diu, who operate for daily fishing in small FRP Gillnetters fitted with outboard motor engines (OBMs). Both the Union Minister and Administrator of UT have taken note of various suggestions given by the traditional fishermen towards further development of fisheries in the UT.

Union Minister Sh. Rupala also visited other areas of traditional fishermen, informed about the government schemes and programs and encouraged them to take benefit under various schemes including PMMSY and avail loan under KCC. Representatives of different fishermen associations and communities participated in these interaction program with Hon'ble Minister.

The *Yatra* was graced by the presence of eminent dignitaries, including Dr. L. Murugan, Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting & Fishries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, State Ministers, MPs and MLAs of the coastal areas, senior officials from Government of India,, State/UT, Indian Coast Guard, Fishing Community Leaders, Fish-Industry Leaders, etc. Attended by nearly 3,500 persons, the event witnessed many cultural events depicting the Gujarati tradition and KCC certificates distribution to the beneficiaries.

It was an inspiring and impactful effort by Hon'ble Minister to address the concerns of fishermen and encouraged them in availing various schemes and KCC loans for their betterment. The

